



Champion again: Mumbai Indians won the Women's Premier League for the second time with an eight-run victory over Delhi Capitals in the final.

EMMANUAL YOGINI

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The Women's Premier League (WPL) was meant to be a fresh start for Indian women's cricket. While the BCCI took control of the women's game in 2006, the domestic structure remained inconsistent and was largely dominated by the Railways.

Despite its resilience on the international stage, the national team often faltered in high-pressure moments, exposing the gaps in the system. The lack of a structured pathway for young talent led to

growing calls for a women's version of the IPL more than a decade ago.

That vision materialised in 2023 with the launch of the WPL, a five-team tournament designed to provide the much-needed platform for the country's emerging players.

Three seasons later, the first official cycle is complete — a phase where the BCCI sought to test its commercial viability, nurture talent, and build a sustainable future for women's cricket.

In just three years, the league has seen significant changes: a geographical expansion,